



REQUEST FOR PROPOSALS

GENERAL LEGAL SERVICES

DATE ISSUED: April 20, 2026

VILLAGE OF SARANAC LAKE
39 MAIN ST, SUITE 9
SARANAC LAKE, NY 12983
518-891-4150

REQUEST FOR PROPOSALS FOR GENERAL LEGAL SERVICES

1. INTRODUCTION AND PURPOSE

The Village of Saranac Lake ("Village"), a municipal corporation in the State of New York, is soliciting proposals from qualified attorneys and/or law firms to provide General Legal Services in the role of Village Attorney.

This Request for Proposals (RFP) is issued to assist the Village Board of Trustees in making an appointment to the position of Village Attorney through a fair, transparent, and competitive process consistent with municipal best practices and the Village's procurement policies.

DATE ISSUED: April 20, 2026

RESPONSES DUE: May 8, 2026

2. NATURE OF ENGAGEMENT

This solicitation is intended to identify qualified candidates for appointment as Village Attorney.

Selection pursuant to this RFP does not constitute a contractual award. The Village Board of Trustees retains full discretion to appoint or not appoint any respondent.

The Village Attorney shall be appointed for a one (1) year term, subject to annual reappointment, and shall serve at the pleasure of the appointing authority in accordance with New York State Village Law.

3. SCOPE OF SERVICES

The selected attorney and/or law firm will provide a full range of municipal legal services, including but not limited to:

- Advising the Village Board on legal implications of policies, actions, and administrative decisions
- Assisting Village departments, boards, and commissions in the execution of their duties
- Attending regular and special Village Board meetings, as well as other meetings as requested
- Providing guidance on compliance with applicable laws, including but not limited to:
 - Freedom of Information Law (FOIL)

- Open Meetings Law (OML)
 - Ethics and municipal governance requirements
- Providing legal opinions to the Development Board and other administrative boards
- Representing the Village in litigation and administrative proceedings
- Assisting with drafting local laws, resolutions, contracts, and other legal documents

The Village Attorney represents the Village as a municipal entity, acting through the Village Board, and not individual officers or employees except as authorized.

The Village reserves the right to retain special counsel for specific matters as it deems necessary.

4. EXPECTATIONS AND QUALIFICATIONS

Respondents should demonstrate:

- Experience in municipal law in New York State
- Knowledge of local government operations and statutory compliance
- Experience in areas such as labor law, land use, litigation, procurement, and regulatory compliance
- Ability to provide timely legal advice and respond to routine and urgent matters
- Capacity to attend meetings and be accessible to Village officials

5. SUBMISSION REQUIREMENTS

Respondents must submit:

- A summary of qualifications and relevant experience
- Resume(s) of attorney(s) who will provide services
- Description of experience with municipal clients
- Proposed fee structure (hourly rates, retainers, or flat fees, as applicable)
- Proof of professional liability insurance
- Disclosure of any actual or potential conflicts of interest, including how such conflicts would be addressed
- Non-collusion certification as required by law
- Disclosure of any professional or financial relationships with the Village

6. EVALUATION CRITERIA

The Village will evaluate proposals based on factors including, but not limited to:

- Demonstrated ability to provide municipal legal services
- Relevant experience and qualifications
- Responsiveness and completeness of proposal
- Fee structure and cost considerations
- Familiarity with New York municipal law

The Village reserves the right to:

- Request additional information
- Conduct interviews with selected respondents
- Negotiate terms with one or more respondents

7. PROCUREMENT AND RESERVATIONS

This RFP is issued in accordance with the Village's procurement policies and applicable provisions of New York State law.

The Village reserves the right to:

- Reject any or all proposals
- Waive any informalities or irregularities in proposals
- Accept the proposal deemed most advantageous to the Village
- Terminate the engagement at any time, with or without cause, in accordance with applicable law

Proposals shall remain valid for a period of 60 days from the submission deadline.

Late submissions will not be accepted.

8. ADDITIONAL INFORMATION

Questions regarding this RFP may be directed to the Village Managers Office at:

Village of Saranac Lake
39 Main Street, Suite 9
Saranac Lake, NY 12983

The RFP will also be available on the Village's website:

www.saranaclakeny.gov

9. NON-DISCRIMINATION

The Village of Saranac Lake is an equal opportunity employer and encourages submissions from qualified minority- and women-owned business enterprises (MWBE).

RESPONSES DUE AND SUBMISSION INSTRUCTIONS

Responses are due no later than Friday, May 8, 2026 at 2:00 PM.

All proposals must be submitted to:

Bachana Tsiklauri, Village Manager
Village of Saranac Lake
39 Main Street, Suite 9
Saranac Lake, NY 12983
manager@saranaclakeny.gov

Kelly Brunette, Mayor
Village of Saranac Lake
39 Main Street, Suite 9
Saranac Lake, NY 12983
mayorbrunette@saranaclakeny.gov

Electronic submissions are required and must be received by the deadline.

Proposals may be submitted via email to:

manager@saranaclakeny.gov and mayorbrunette@saranaclakeny.gov

If submitting hard copies, proposals must be received at the above address by the deadline. Late submissions will not be accepted.